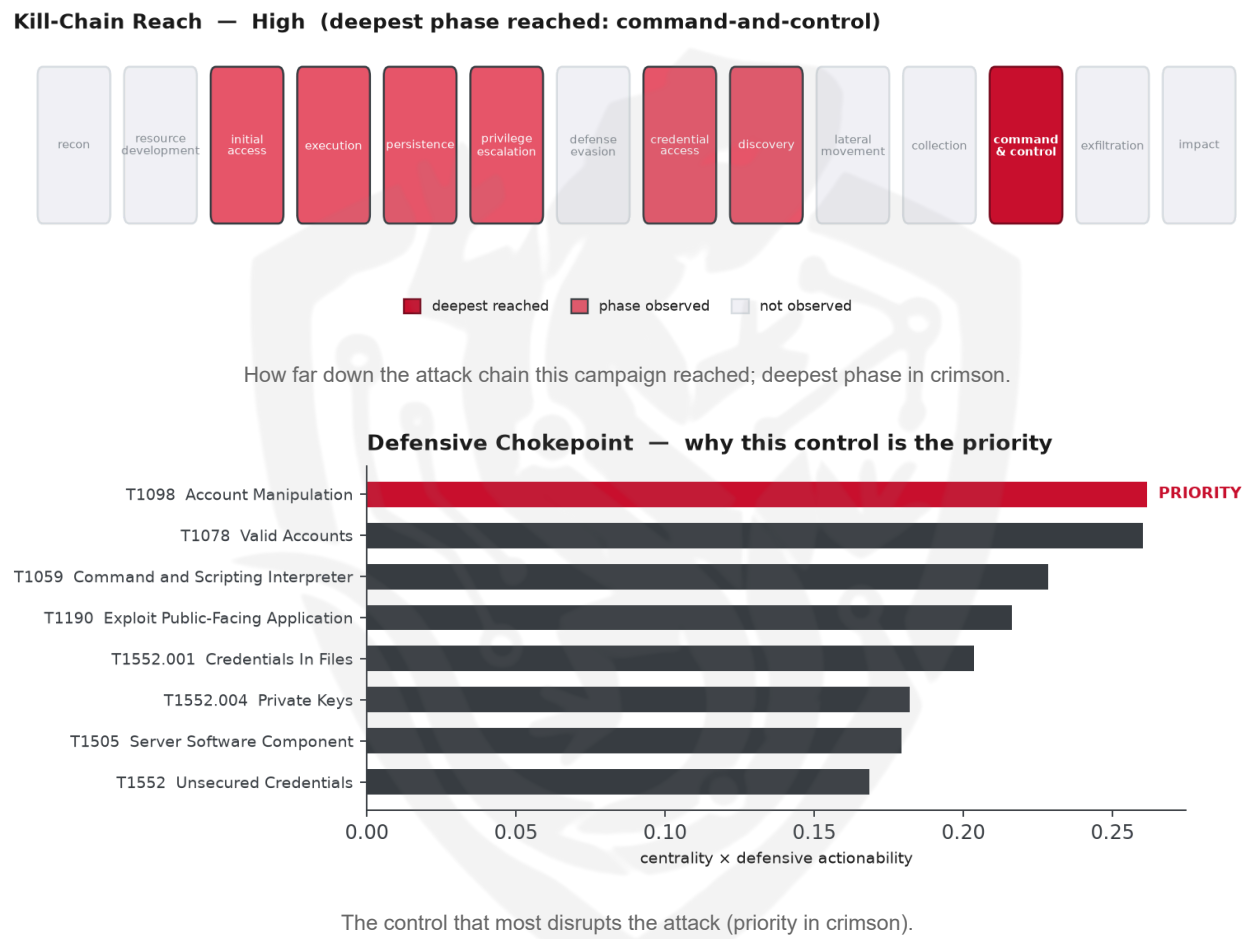


THREAT REPORT: ARTIFACTORY EXPLOITED VIA CVE-2026-82329 AND RELATED FLAWS

Visual Summary



Summary

A cluster of activity targeting JFrog Artifactory installations is exploiting multiple recently disclosed vulnerabilities, most notably CVE-2026-82329. The campaign leverages a range of ATT&CK techniques to gain initial access, enumerate the environment, and manipulate accounts. No specific malware family or adversary has been identified. Priority should be given to alerting on privilege or group changes (Event ID 4738/4670) and reviewing conditional-access modifications, while promptly patching CVE-2026-82329 on all vulnerable systems.

Threat Overview

The observed cluster of activity, without a confirmed attribution, is focused on compromising Artifactory services. No malware family has been linked to the operations. Exploitation centers on CVE-2026-82329

together with CVE-2026-42016 and CVE-2026-42018, which are public-facing application flaws. Victims are organizations that deploy Artifactory for artifact storage and distribution.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The attackers appear to follow a multi-step chain: they first exploit the public-facing application (T1190) using the cited CVEs, then conduct system and account discovery (T1082, T1087, T1087.001, T1087.004, T1069). Credential harvesting follows (T1552, T1552.001, T1552.004), after which they create or modify system processes (T1543) and establish persistence via account creation and manipulation (T1136, T1098). Lateral movement and command execution are facilitated through web protocols (T1071.001) and scripting interpreters (T1059). The chokepoint technique identified as priority is **T1098 Account Manipulation**.

Priority control: *Alert on privilege/group changes and credential additions to accounts (Event ID 4738/4670); review conditional-access changes. In parallel, patch CVE-2026-82329 on all affected systems.*

Infrastructure and Corroboration

Third-party enrichment shows the command-and-control infrastructure is hosted by providers including Dromatics Systems Pte Ltd, Mediatecom, Superonline İletişim Hizmetleri A.Ş., and Akari Networks, spanning multiple ASNs. AbuseIPDB flags one indicator with an 88 % confidence rating as malicious. No additional malware families have been corroborated by abuse.ch.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1543 Create or Modify System Process
- T1069 Permission Groups Discovery
- T1087.001 Local Account
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application
- T1552 Unsecured Credentials
- T1552.004 Private Keys
- T1087 Account Discovery
- T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter
- T1083 File and Directory Discovery
- T1552.001 Credentials In Files
- T1087.004 Cloud Account
- T1098 Account Manipulation

- T1078 Valid Accounts
- T1068 Exploitation for Privilege Escalation
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1505 Server Software Component
- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1136 Create Account
- T1018 Remote System Discovery
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1098 Account Manipulation (centrality 0.2753).
- Operational risk: High (score 0.636, reaches command-and-control).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.402; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
APT18	0.402
APT3	0.385
Fox Kitten	0.3772
Medusa Group	0.3767
Ke3chang	0.3761

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 88%.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	146[.]19[.]216[.]120	AbuseIPDB 11% (US) · AS134677 Dromatics Systems Pte Ltd
IP	105[.]188[.]75[.]16	AbuseIPDB 88% (MA) · AS36925 Mediatecom
IP	176[.]88[.]121[.]152	AbuseIPDB 0% (TR) · AS34984 Superonline II etisim Hizmetleri A.S.
IP	155[.]254[.]120[.]23	AbuseIPDB 0% (SG) · AS38136 Akari Networks
IP	182[.]62[.]201[.]69	AbuseIPDB 0% (MY) · AS4818 DiGi Telecommunications Sdn. Bhd.
IP	185[.]190[.]58[.]172	AbuseIPDB 27% (SG) · AS152900 Onidel Pty Ltd
IP	220[.]246[.]124[.]92	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS4760 HKT Limited
IP	223[.]144[.]227[.]110	AbuseIPDB 0% (CN) · AS4134 China Telecom
IP	64[.]207[.]232[.]6	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · AS22773 Cox Communications Inc.
IP	93[.]104[.]155[.]133	AbuseIPDB 0% (DE) · AS8767 M-Net Telekomunikations GmbH
Domain	log[.]gitclone[.]org	
URL	hxxp://log[.]gitclone[.]org:45678/smtp	
Hash	ac6c52632fcf8b072be3b1c5bc076fdd	
Hash	513a907b69edffc3cb77a494da395178d21ef9bd	
Hash	6639abda5778b31cc049e4af0a71da04750afda97d44eec3dd202d32e3e2496	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1098 Account Manipulation (persistence)

- **Observed here:** T1098 Account Manipulation was the only persistence technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution (persistence)
- **Basis:** of the 12+ groups that use Account Manipulation, this pairing runs 2.0x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

With T1098 Account Manipulation blocked, the threat actor could preserve the same objective by pivoting to T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution, a technique disproportionately paired with it across tracked groups. Defensive countermeasure: Baseline and monitor autostart locations (Run keys, startup folders); alert on new persistence entries.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1542 Pre-OS Boot (n=3, lift 7.1), T1133 External Remote Services (n=10, lift 3.4)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution)

- **Telemetry:** Sysmon (registry + process); EDR autostart/ASEP inventory
- **Detect:**
 - Sysmon 13 (registry value set) on Run/RunOnce keys under HKLM & HKCU
...\\CurrentVersion\\Run*
 - Sysmon 11 for shortcuts/scripts created in Startup folders
 - Periodic ASEP (autostart extensibility point) diff against a known-good baseline
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict write access to autostart registry keys and Startup folders
 - Application control to block unsigned autostart binaries
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1038 Execution Prevention · DS0019 Service, DS0024 Windows Registry, DS0022 File